

ESPON · European territorial analysis

What this tool produces · *A territorial analysis report detailing how demographic shifts, functional economic areas, and proposed policies interact across municipal and regional borders.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

G3 · Proof of Anchoring

Dimensions

Spatial

Economic

Preparing the workshop · *ESPON · European territorial analysis*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Erasing the artificial borders drawn by administrators to reveal the true, living geography of daily human movement, commuting, and economic survival.

Evidence we produce

A territorial analysis report detailing how demographic shifts, functional economic areas, and proposed policies interact across municipal and regional borders.

Duration & Material

Duration · 4 to 8 weeks

Material · ESPON Database Portal, GIS software, Territorial Impact Assessment (TIA) tools

Reference case

Managing Authorities utilize ESPON's territorial tools to design cohesion policy strategies. For example, specific analyses of small and medium-sized towns and cities (SMSTCs) enabled policymakers to understand their crucial role in regional networks. This evidence-based approach allowed authorities to tailor Community-Led Local Development (CLLD) funding to strengthen active, inclusive territories, rather than imposing one-size-fits-all metropolitan models on smaller commun...

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Functional territory analysis · macro × micro

Duration
4 to 8 weeks

Functional Urban Area

commute-shed, not admin border

Polycentricity

multi-node networks

Cohesion

territorial · economic · social

Cross-border flows

goods · people · data

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.